to having over 10 lakh COVID-19 isolation care beds, 7 lakh non-COVID hospital beds with 5 lakh enabled for oxygen delivery and 2 lakh ICU beds including 1.2 lakh ventilated beds. Five per cent of the ICU beds and 4 per cent of non-ICU beds were recommended to be earmarked for paediatric care. To enable this, India would need to further scale up around 80,000 ICU beds and over 1 lakh oxygen-enabled non-ICU beds as against the current status of availability. To enable judicious use of resources, the Group prepared a threadbare structure of a 'COVID saral ICU' which can be particularly erected as make-shift structures in rural and peri-urban areas, where populations are excessively vulnerable due to less exposure to the virus. The report also drew attention to realign preparedness to tackle a potential upsurge in disease in paediatric groups. However, if we are able to achieve wide vaccine coverage as planned and delay the surge by being vigilant, we may be able to escape a particularly fatal third wave.

21 OCTOBER 2021

INDIA | 1,82,548 ACTIVE CASES | 4,53,076 DEATHS | 100 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

WORLD | 1,78,57,909 ACTIVE CASES | 49,45,246 DEATHS | 381 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

On 21 October, India crossed the mark of administering 1 billion vaccine doses to its people. A remarkable feat for the prime minister-led government machinery, the vaccine ecosystem and the healthcare workers of the country! In a televised address to the nation, the prime minister expressed his contentment and gratitude,

> 100 crore vaccinations are not just a figure, but a reflection of the strength of the country, it is the creation of a new chapter of history. This is a picture of a new India that sets difficult goals and knows how to achieve them. While people are comparing our vaccination program to others around the world, the speed with which we have administered 1 billion doses is being appreciated. However, they often miss the point of where India began from. Developed countries had decades of expertise in researching and developing vaccines. India mostly depended on vaccines made by these